

The Return of the Iron Man

One evening, Hogarth was fishing by the sea. It grew dark, so he stopped. He heard the sea say, "Hush, hush, hush." Then he felt scared. He looked up at the cliff and saw two green lights.



The lights rose up into the sky. It was the Iron Man! He had come back. Hogarth ran home as fast as he could and told his dad. His dad did not believe him, but he took his gun and drove out to look. At the farm next door, they found a tractor bitten clean in half. There were giant teeth marks in the steel.

That night, Hogarth's dad drove home through the rain. Suddenly, a huge iron foot landed in the road! A giant hand reached down towards the car. He crashed into the foot and sped away. Behind him, the Iron Man came crashing down onto the road.



The next morning, all the farm machines were gone. Tractors, ploughs and diggers had vanished. Giant footprints led across the fields, all the way back to the cliff. The tracks slid down the rocks and into the sea.



The furious farmers dug a huge, deep hole to trap the Iron Man. They covered it with branches and soil, so it looked like a normal field. They put an old red lorry nearby as bait, and waited.



Day after day, the Iron Man did not come. So Hogarth used the hole to try to catch a fox instead. One evening, he climbed a tree and waited quietly.

Suddenly, Hogarth saw the Iron Man on the cliff top again! He watched the giant come down the hill, tearing up the wire fences and eating them as he went.

Hogarth took a nail and a knife from his pocket. He tapped them together — clink, clink, clink! The sound made the Iron Man turn his head. Slowly, the giant walked towards the sound, straight towards the trap.

CRASH! The Iron Man fell into the deep hole. Hogarth ran home shouting, "We've caught the Iron Giant!"

The farmers cheered. They pushed the earth on top of the Iron Man until he was buried under a great mound. They were sure they had seen the last of him. But Hogarth felt guilty — it was he who had led the Iron Man into the trap.